

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X

Donell Hawes	:	Index Number:
	:	Date Purchased:
	:	Date Filed:
Plaintiff	:	SUMMONS
-against-	:	
City of New York, New York City Police Department,	:	
Detective Massiel Pages, Shield 1435 of NARCBBX,	:	
Undercover Police Officer, Shield 0361 of NARCBBX	:	
and New York City Police Officers John Doe,	:	
	:	Plaintiff's residence is:
	:	22 East 112 Street
	:	New York, NY 10029
Defendants	:	
-----X	:	

TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to Answer the Verified Complaint in this action and serve a copy of your answer, or if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons to serve a notice of Appearance on the Plaintiffs attorney within twenty (20) days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within thirty (30) days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York) and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Verified Complaint.

The basis of venue designated is that the cause of action arose in Bronx County.

Dated: November 12, 2020
Bronx, NY

Yours, etc.,

LAW OFFICES OF JASON A. STEINBERGER, LLC
Attorney for Plaintiff
505 Eighth Avenue
Suite 701
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

To: City of New York

New York City Police Department

Detective Massiel Pages, Shield 1435 of NARCB BX

Undercover Police Officer, Shield 0361 of NARCB BX

New York City Police Officers John Doe

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X	:	
Donell Hawes	:	
	:	
Plaintiff	:	VERIFIED COMPLAINT
-against-	:	
City of New York, New York City Police Department,	:	
Detective Massiel Pages, Shield 1435 of NARCB BX,	:	
Undercover Police Officer, Shield 0361 of NARCB BX	:	
and New York City Police Officers John Doe,	:	
	:	
Defendants.	:	
-----X	:	

Plaintiff, by and through his attorney, JASON A. STEINBERGER, Esq, for his complaint,
alleges upon information and belief as follows:

STATEMENT OF FACTS

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Plaintiff Donell Hawes, (hereinafter referred to a "LYLES") is resident of Bronx County, State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Detective Massiel Pages, Shield 1435 of NARCB BX, (hereinafter referred to as "PAGES") was employed by the New York City Police Department.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Undercover Police Officer, Shield 0361 of NARCB BX, (hereinafter referred to as "UC 361") was employed by the New York City Police Department.

4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, New York City Police Officers John Doe, the officers involved in the arrest of HAWES, (hereinafter referred to as "DOE") was employed by the New York City Police Department.

5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant City of New York, is a municipal corporation organized and existing under the laws of the State of New York, with a principal place of business located at 1 Centre Street, County of New York State of New York.

6. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, Defendant New York City Police Department, is an agency created and maintained by the above municipal government.

7. On or about July 19, 2019 notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to City of New York, by personal service. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiff's claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York.

8. On or about November 12, 2020 amended notice required by Municipal Law 50-E was given to City of New York, by personal service. Said notice set forth the facts underlying Plaintiff's claim against the City of New York, and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York.

9. On or about December 17, 2019 a hearing required by Municipal Law 50-H was conducted. At said hearing, Plaintiff testified and set forth the facts underlying Plaintiff's claim against the City of New York and its agents and employees. To date, no answer has been received by Plaintiff and no compensation has been offered by the City of New York in response to this claim, and more than thirty (30) days have elapsed.

10. That on or about July 12, 2019, at approximately 2:30 PM in the vicinity of East 165 Street and Tinton Avenue, Bronx, NY Plaintiff was on his way towards the subway to go home when he stopped to speak briefly with some friends, after which PAGES and DOES then stopped, handcuffed and arrested him.

11. That at no time did Plaintiff engage in any criminal or unlawful conduct

12. That at no time did Plaintiff sell any marijuana.

13. That at no time did Plaintiff possess any marijuana.

14. Despite having not engaged in any criminal or unlawful conduct, UC 361 communicated to PAGES and DOES that he did.

15. Despite receiving information from UC 361, PAGES and DOES knew Plaintiff had not engaged in a crime and then arrested him anyway.

16. That after Plaintiff was arrested he was 40 police precinct.

17. That while Plaintiff was in the 40 police precinct, he was subjected to a strip search and that nothing of an illegal nature was found.

18. That while Plaintiff was in the 40 police precinct, he placed in a cell with other males for several hours.

19. That after being held in a cell inside of the PSA 7 police precinct for several hours, Plaintiff was transferred to Bronx County Central Booking located at 215 East 161 Street, Bronx, New York.

20. That on or about July 13, 2019 Plaintiff was arraigned in Bronx County Criminal Court on docket 2019BX018815 charging him with Criminal Sale of Marijuana and related offenses.

21. That at the time of the arraignment, my client was released from custody and ordered to return to court.

22. That on and between July 13, 2019 and March 5, 2020 Plaintiff made several court appearances until the Office of the Bronx District Attorney dismissed the case.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

23. That Defendants acted with actual malice toward Plaintiff and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of the Plaintiff.

24. That the actions of the Defendants constituted unreasonable deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

25. That as a result of the actions by Defendants, Plaintiff was traumatized and fears for her physical safety when she sees and encounter members of the New York City Police Department from the day of his arrest and onward.

26. That as a result of the Defendants' actions, Plaintiff has been unable to sleep.

27. That as a result of Defendants' actions, Plaintiff missed several days of work.

28. That as a result of the Defendants' actions Plaintiff sustained damage to her person in the sum within the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANTS

29. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 28, as if more fully stated herein at length.

30. The intentional verbal abuse, false arrest and false imprisonment by Defendants violated the rights of the Plaintiff as guaranteed by the Fourth, Fifth and Eighth Amendments to the Unites States Constitution, as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable.

31. Defendants having no lawful authority to arrest Plaintiff, did, nevertheless, unlawfully arrest Plaintiff with actual malice toward her and with willful and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for her constitutional rights. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

32. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 31, as if more fully stated herein at length.

33. Defendants conspired to violate Plaintiff's statutory civil rights in violation of 42 U.S.C. sec.1983, et al as well as the corresponding sections of the New York State Constitution, for which Defendants are individually liable. Thus Plaintiff is entitled to both compensatory and exemplary damages, as well as attorney's fees.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

34. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 33, as if more fully stated herein at length.

35. Plaintiff was verbally abused, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted by Defendants in a manner that was extreme, outrageous and unjustified and caused Plaintiff to suffer physical and severe emotional distress for which the Defendants are individually liable. The verbal abuse, false arrest, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution on and of Plaintiff by Defendants were unjustified and done with actual malice and wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory and exemplary damages.

36. That knowing that Plaintiff had not sold or possessed marijuana, PAGES, UC 361 and DOES persisted in their claims that he had in an effort to continue the prosecution against Plaintiff.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

37. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 36, as if more fully stated herein at length.

38. At all times pertinent hereto, PAGES, UC 361 and DOES were acting within the scope of their employment as officers of the New York City Police Department and City of New York.

39. The City of New York and New York City Police Department are each liable for compensatory damages under the doctrine of respondeat superior for the intentional torts that PAGES, UC 361 and DOES were committed within the scope of their employment.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST CITY OF NEW YORK AND
NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

40. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 39, as if more fully stated herein at length.

41. The City of New York and New York City Police Department's failure to provide adequate training and supervision to PAGES, UC 361 and DOES constitutes a willful and wanton indifference and deliberate disregard for human life and the rights of private citizens, including Plaintiff. Plaintiff is thus entitled to compensatory exemplary damages.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION AS AGAINST DEFENDANTS

42. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges the allegations contained in paragraphs 1 through 41, as if more fully stated herein at length.

43. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted and tolerated the unreasonable detention of Plaintiff.

44. Upon information and belief, the City of New York and New York City Police Department maintained a system of review of police conduct which was so untimely and cursory that it was ineffective and permitted the wanton indifference to and deliberate disregard for the statutory and constitutional rights of Plaintiff.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiffs each demand judgment against the Defendants as follows:

On the first cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts;

On the second cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts, together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

On the third cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the willful and wanton nature of Defendants actions.

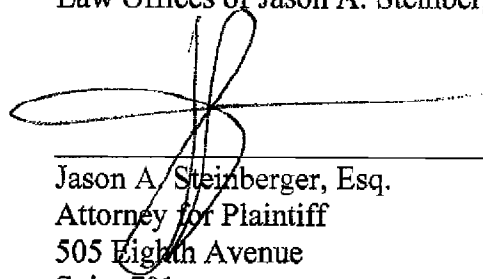
On the fourth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts owing to the wanton and willful nature of the Defendants actions;

On the fifth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts

On the sixth cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of the of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts together with the additional exemplary sum within the jurisdiction of this court and in excess of all inferior courts.

On the seventh cause of action, a sum within the jurisdiction of this Court and in excess of all inferior courts.

Law Offices of Jason A. Steinberger, LLC

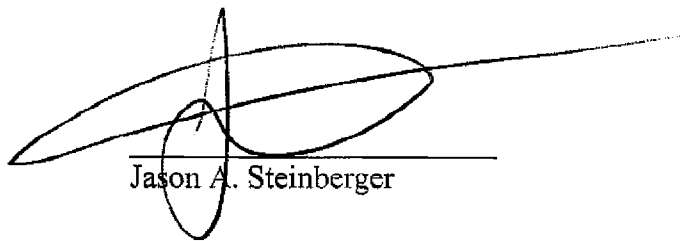


Jason A. Steinberger, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff
505 Eighth Avenue
Suite 701
New York, NY 10018
(646) 256-1007

STATE OF NEW YORK: COUNTY OF NEW YORK

The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the State of New York, under penalties of perjury, affirms the following to be true: Affirmant has read the foregoing Complaint and the contents thereof; the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge, except as to matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief and as to those matters affirmant believes it to be true; and the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not by the plaintiff is because the plaintiff is not within the county in which your affirmant maintains his principal office. The grounds of affirmant's belief as to all matters not stated upon affirmant's knowledge are communications with the plaintiff, review of records and documents within affirmant's possession.

Affirmed: November 12, 2020



Jason A. Steinberger